First News

13 April 2026 Friday

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

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Global, Regional Markets

U.S.-Iran talks pause for now as disagreements remain.

Blackstone Inc. has reportedly filed for a $2 billion initial public offering (IPO) for a new acquisition vehicle specifically designed to buy already-built and leased data centers.

Three supertankers hauling crude from Saudi Arabia and Iraq were observed exiting the Persian Gulf through the Strait of Hormuz on Saturday morning Two Chinese-owned with Saudi & Iraqi crude, heading out of the Gulf, but have yet to cross the apex of Hormuz.

President Trump posted on social media Friday that Tehran's only leverage is "short term extortion of the world by using International Waterways" — a reference to Hormuz, a critical shipping lane for oil and natural gas that remains largely shut.

Iran, US and Pakistan Begin a New Round of Talks

Wall Street ended the day on Friday, April 10, 2026, with modestly mixed results, capping a strong week for U.S. stocks as investors digested a hotter-than-expected inflation report and ongoing geopolitical tensions.

Switch Diessel/Gas to EV

- Shares of Chinese electric-vehicle makers jump after data showed the nation's exports of EVs and hybrids more than doubled in March to a record, as the global energy shock stemming from the Iran war renewed interest in the sector.

UKRAINE: Zelenskiy's top aide Kyrylo Budanov see Ukraine nearing a deal with Putin.

- "They all understand the war needs to end. That's why they are negotiating,"
- "I don't think it will be long."
- Chief of the Military Intelligence of Ukraine Kyrylo Budanov

Bank of Korea Holds Interest Rate at 2.5%, Expected

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Global, Regional Markets

Lower commodity prices have lowered the risk of stagflation (high inflation plus slow growth) hurting the markets.

- **However, some investments are still priced incorrectly or at the wrong value.**

The U.S. is pushing Israel to low-key military actions to save the Iran ceasefire, but Netanyahu is doubling down. By insisting the truce doesn't cover Lebanon Continued strikes risk collapsing the Islamabad talks, sinks U.S. deeper into a war it's trying to exit.

Asian markets are experiencing a tug-of-war, with Japanese stocks surging on a massive $18.65b foreign influx driven by seasonal dividend buying.

- However, broader regional gains, KOSPI & Shanghai, are capped by rising geopolitical uncertainty, on a fragile US-Iran ceasefire.

IMF-WORLD BANK SPRING MEETINGS + ASIA FOOD SECURITY RISK

- Global Economy "Under Strain" as IMF/WB Meetings Open April 13–18
- IMF Managing Director Kristalina Georgieva said addressing economic shocks from the Middle East war will be the central agenda of the 2026 Spring Meetings, warning that even in the "most hopeful scenario" there will be a downgrade to global growth as the war has caused permanent damage to energy sectors worldwide.
- The World Bank has separately revised Philippine GDP growth down to 3.7% — the most pessimistic cut yet from a multilateral — while projecting emerging market inflation rising to 4.9%. Adding a second-order risk, fuel and fertilizer shortages from the Strait of Hormuz disruption are threatening rice production across Southeast Asia, with Philippine paddy output potentially falling 10% or roughly 2 million tons this year, compounding food inflation risks through the September–October harvest season.
- Market Implication: The IMF/WB meetings are unlikely to produce immediate relief for the Philippines but could catalyze emergency lending facilities or coordinated policy guidance. Rice price risk adds to CPI upside; agri-linked conglomerates with diversified food portfolios (JGS, LTG) may face input cost pressures, while grocery retailers face inventory management challenges.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	4/10/2026	4/13/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	48,185	47,916	-0.56%
S&P 500	6,824	6,816	-0.12%
NASDAQ	22,822	22,902	0.35%
PCOMP	6,089	6,098	0.15%
NKY	55,895	56,924	1.84%
SHCOMP	3966	3986	0.50%
HSI	25,752	25,893	0.55%
KOSPI	5778	5858	1.38%
SENSEX	76,631	77,550	1.20%
TWSE	34,861	35,417	1.59%
ASX200	8973	8960	-0.14%
BURSAKLCI	1686	1691	0.30%
JCI	7307	7458	2.07%
STI	4977	4989	0.24%
SET	985	989	0.41%
VNINDEX	1736	1750	0.81%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	4/10/2026	4/13/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	98.5	104.53	6.12%
Brent Crude	96.67	102.78	6.32%
Gold (Comex)	4781	4702	-1.65%
Silver (Comex)	75.32	73.93	-1.85%
Copper (Comex)	575	585.75	1.87%
Nickel	7.7118	7.7239	0.16%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.8%	76.5	76.5	0.00%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5%	92.5	92.5	0.00%
Coal	135.5	134.9	-0.44%
Corn	445.5	445.5	0.00%
Wheat	575.25	590.75	2.69%
Cocoa	3240	3327	2.69%
Sugar	13.92	13.89	-0.22%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

Philippines

This recovery reflects a tentative return to market "hope".. yet persistent concerns about lasting peace and energy costs maintain an undercurrent of risk.

Philippines Jan. Foreign Direct Investment Net Inflows at $443M

SoftBank Sets 4.97% 5-Year Fixed Rate on Hybrid Notes Due 2061

- *Hybrid notes are sophisticated financial instruments that blend the characteristics of debt and equity

Global investors net buy Friday: ICT TEL PLUS CEB DITO COSCO MBT EW ONB APX SCC ALI SMPH MRC LTG AC AEV PCOR CREIT SGP

Global investors net sellers Friday: URC SM GTCAP AP LPZ CNPF PGOLD MYNLND MWC MER SHLPH BPI BDO RCR BLOOM CNVRG PX AT OGP

USD/PHP 59.65

- S&P Global Ratings lowered its outlook on the Philippines to stable from positive due to the war in the Middle East S&P says that while the conflict may ease in April, disruptions could persist in the coming months

BBM Rolls Out Fuel Subsidies as Iran War Wounds

President Marcos Jr. appointed Dita Angara-Mathay as the new Secretary of the Department of Tourism A veteran trade diplomat, Angara-Mathay served as the Commercial Counselor & Special Trade Representative at the Philippine Trade and Investment Center in Tokyo, Japan.

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

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Philippines

MACRO SCORECARD — COMBINED SOVEREIGN & GROWTH RISKS

- **S&P Cuts Outlook to Stable; ADB Slashes GDP Forecast to 4.4%; FDI Slips; Borrowings Surge**
- Multiple headwinds crystallized in the week post-Holy Week: S&P Global revised the Philippines' sovereign outlook to "stable" from "positive" while affirming the BBB+ rating, citing the Middle East war's impact on the country's external and fiscal metrics. Fx The downgrade effectively pushes the Marcos administration's "A-rating" goal past its 2028 term. ADB cut its 2026 Philippine GDP growth forecast to 4.4% from 5.3%, matching last year's pace and falling below the government's 5–6% target, as inflation — already breaching the 2–4% band at 4.1% in March — is projected to hit 4% for the full year under the baseline scenario.
- Fiscal pressures are also building: gross government borrowings surged 41% to ₱478.8 billion in February, driven by a tripling of domestic bond issuances as external borrowings fell 22%.
- FDI net inflows fell 39% year-on-year to $443 million in January — a four-month low — as geopolitical uncertainty dampened investor commitments. The banking sector's NPL ratio edged up to a six-month high of 3.33% in February, though provisioning remains adequate at a 93.83% coverage ratio.
- Market Implication: The confluence of sovereign outlook revision, growth downgrades, tightening fiscal space, and softening FDI reinforces a defensive posture in equities. Domestic consumption names, dividend-paying REITs, and utilities with pass-through mechanisms offer relative resilience. Avoid high-leverage, externally exposed names.

PESO WATCH

- **Peso to Move Sideways; Recovery Hinges on US-Iran Ceasefire**
- The peso is expected to trade sideways against the dollar this week, with the market watching for progress in US-Iran negotiations.
- The currency hit an all-time low of ₱60.748 in late March before partially recovering; analysts note that any sustained ceasefire would ease oil import pressure and support peso stability. The diesel rollback effective April 14 — linked to the temporary ceasefire — provides a near-term inflation floor.
- BSP held rates steady at 4.25% at its March off-cycle meeting; the April 23 Monetary Board meeting will be closely watched for guidance on whether further hikes are possible if May electricity and fuel cost passthrough accelerates inflation.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control,

6098 8.30pts., 0.14%

Range 6,095.11-6,151.80

Breadth 100 (+) 102 (-) 66 (unch)

Block Php431mn **Volume** 638mn **Value** Php6.91bn

Share buyback MEG OPM AGI

52wk H: apx bncom crec dhi sgp

52wk L: allhc gsmi mrsgi pax

Overbought – allhc gsmi mrsgi pax

Oversold – stn gsmi tfhi abs atn

Active	Value
ICT	1400
ALI	418
BDO	408
MBT	374
JFC	354
APX	272
SM	262
BPI	242
PLUS	200

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$725.224mn
Total Month FB/(FS)	-$96.106mn
YTD NFB	$84.319mn
FB	3,922,822,516.70
FS	3,921,309,034.81
NFB(S)	1,513,481.89
TOTAL	7,844,131,551.51

Foreign Funds Bought
bncom cbc ew mbt pnb secb acen alter ap pcor scc sgp ani emi fcg cic green aba aev cosco ltg ali creit mrc mreit rlc rock shng dito glo tel ceb ict mac plus web alldy apx px

Foreign Funds Sold
bdo bpi dhi pse acr mer mwc mynld shlph spc spnec cnpf dnl gsmi jfc keepr monde rfm urc mwide imi ac agi dmc gtcap jgs lpz sm smc areit egrn meg rcr smph vreit cnvrg bloom pgold rrhi wlcon at nikl ogp

Global Funds Net Buyers
Wednesday 4/8/26: ICT GLO SGP CREIT BDO MBT PNB APX PX SCC PLUS IMI AEV JGS DMC LTG AP PGOLD MONDE MAC

	4/8/2…	4/10…	%Chg
10yr Bond			
PHL	6.606	6.545	-0.92%
US	4.284	4.35	1.54%
Currency Pair			
USD-JPY	159.21	159.27	0.64%
USD-PHP	59.753	59.989	0.06%
USD-CNY	6.8383	6.8292	0.24%
EUR-USD	1.1685	1.1723	-0.35%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

MER 608.50

- Meralco rates are up ₱0.5335/kWh this April, driven by a weak peso.
- The generation charge rose to ₱8.3864, bringing the total rate for typical households to ₱14.35/kWh.
- Note: This hike doesn’t yet include potential fuel spikes from Middle East tensions.

- MER Q1 energy sales dipped on La Niña cooling effects, as expected. Full-year 3% volume growth remains the target with recovery anchored on Q2 temperature normalization.
- Batangas & GenSan franchise bids are medium-term volume catalysts.

MYNLD 20.75

- Maynilad reported its strongest annual profit in 2025, with net income surging 19% to ₱15.2 billion. For 2026, Maynilad is considered a top dividend candidate, with a projected payout of approximately ₱1.00 per share, implying a high yield of 6.67% to 7.14%.

MEG 2.07

- **Megaworld expanded its LEED-certified office portfolio to 32 properties — the most in the Philippines — after Enterprise Two in Iloilo City secured LEED Gold certification.**
- Provincial IT-BPM demand remains and insulated from OFW remittance headwinds. At ~₱2.09/share

ACEN 2.97

- **A double positive this week: management guided for materially stronger 2026 earnings versus 2025's ₱3.8B net income, driven by restored Ilocos Norte wind output and new plant contributions from Australia and Laos**

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

ALTER 0.82

- Alternergy Holdings Corp. has received regulatory approval for a shelf registration of up to 50m Green Perpetual Preferred Shares to raise as much as ₱5b over the next 5 years.
- Providing the RE ALTER a flexible capital buffer to fund its project pipeline

SCC 30.05
P/E 9.8x
52wk Range 21.20 - 36
Revenue 52.232B
Net Income 13.06B
EPS 3.07
Dividend (Yield)3.25 (10.8%)
Dip buy
Potential Gain: 16.67% (calculated from the current price of 30.0 to the target of 35.0)

-**GLO 1,650.00**

- **Globe Joins Candle Cable System Consortium**
- Globe Telecom's shares rose 2.2% week-on-week to ₱1,650 after the company announced its entry into the Candle Cable System, a regional submarine cable network linking the Philippines to Asia's digital backbone. Globe will participate as both investor and landing party, with the cable landing at its Nasugbu station in Batangas; consortium partners include Meta, SoftBank, NEC, and Telekom Malaysia.
- The move meaningfully strengthens Globe's international capacity profile at a time when digital connectivity has become a strategic national asset. It also diversifies infrastructure exposure beyond the domestic mobile network, which matters increasingly to long-term institutional investors. The share's year-to-date gain of 4.2% lags the services sector's 18% run, suggesting the stock may still have room to catch up as the subsea cable story matures.
- **Stance:** ACCUMULATE — Infrastructure catalyst supports long-term re-rating; entry on weakness.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

PAL 3.37

- **PAL Launches Palau Route, Restores Saipan Service**
- Philippine Airlines inaugurated direct Manila–Palau (Koror) flights and resumed the Manila–Saipan route after a nine-year absence, operating both services twice weekly on Wednesdays and Sundays using Airbus A321ceo aircraft, with PAL positioning Manila as a key Pacific cargo hub alongside the passenger expansion.
- PAL president Richard Nuttall framed the routes as reinforcing Manila's role as a medical tourism and regional transit gateway. The expansion is revenue-additive but modest in scale; more significant is the signal that PAL is resuming offensive network growth while managing the suspension of Dubai and Doha flights until May 31. Affected passengers on suspended Middle East routes may rebook, convert to travel credits with a 20% bonus, or claim full refunds.
- The net capacity impact across the network warrants monitoring as Middle East ceasefire dynamics evolve.
- Stance: MONITOR — Pacific expansion is positive, but Middle East route suspensions and elevated fuel costs cap near-term upside.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

ENERGY

FUEL PRICE ROLLBACK & MERALCO (MER)

- **Diesel Down ₱20+/liter on April 14; Meralco Rate Up ₱0.53/kWh in April**
- The Department of Energy confirmed diesel prices will fall by at least ₱20.89 per liter, gasoline by ₱4.43, and kerosene by ₱8.50 effective April 14 — the first diesel rollback of 2026, enabled partly by Republic Act 12316 which grants the President authority to suspend fuel excise taxes. The relief is linked to a fragile US-Iran ceasefire that briefly eased global crude prices. Separately, Meralco raised April electricity rates by ₱0.5335/kWh to ₱14.3496/kWh, driven by peso depreciation which elevated generation charges; Meralco VP Larry Fernandez noted these April rates do not yet reflect higher fuel costs from the conflict, which are expected to appear in the May billing. Households consuming 200 kWh face a ₱107 higher bill this month, with steeper increases likely in May. The excise tax suspension could reduce diesel by an additional ₱6/liter and gasoline by ₱10/liter if fully implemented.
- **Stance on MER:** MONITOR — Earnings headwinds from peso-linked generation costs persist; May rates to carry the real oil shock. Meralco's regulated pass-through model insulates margins but pressures consumer demand.

COAL COMEBACK & REGIONAL ENERGY RISK

- **Energy Shocks Drive Higher Coal Reliance Across ASEAN**
- The global oil crisis has pushed the Philippines and Southeast Asian peers into heavier coal dependence as a short-term buffer, but this shift is already driving up coal prices and exposing the region to the same commodity volatility it sought to escape, according to Zero Carbon Analytics.
- With coal accounting for over 60% of the Philippine power mix and Indonesia supplying 98% of local coal imports, the risk profile of coal-dependent power generators (SMPC, ACEN, SCC, GEN) has worsened structurally. Analysts note that renewable energy — particularly solar — increasingly presents a more cost-stable and energy-secure alternative. The current crisis is accelerating the policy argument for faster RE deployment, even if near-term capital constraints and grid challenges delay execution.
- **Stance on Coal-Exposed Names (SMPC, SCC):** MONITOR — Near-term coal demand spike supports volumes but coal price risk and energy transition pressure weigh on longer-term multiples. RE developers (ACEN, RLC's renewables arm) remain structurally preferred.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

MAHARLIKA + EV INCENTIVES — ENERGY TRANSITION PLAYS

- G**ov't Finalizes ₱60B EV Incentive Package; Maharlika Backs Energy Diversification**
- The DTI is finalizing a ₱60-billion Electric Vehicle Incentive Strategy (EVIS) executive order covering BEVs, HEVs, and PHEVs, with up to ₱15 billion per qualifying manufacturer over ten years — significantly exceeding the old CARS program's ₱27-billion envelope.Mitsubishi Motors Philippines has already secured EVIS approval to produce a hybrid model locally by 2028. Separately, Maharlika Investment Corp. CEO Rafael Consing confirmed the sovereign wealth fund is anchoring 2026 capital deployment in energy, infrastructure, agriculture, and mining as natural hedges for the economy, with the ₱19.7-billion SGP/NGCP grid stake acquisition still pending closure. BYD Philippines — distributed by Ayala-led AC Mobility — reported a 446% sales jump to 26,122 units in 2025 and is aggressively building inventory in anticipation of oil-shock-driven EV demand acceleration.
- S**tance on AC/IMI (EV supply chain exposure):** MONITOR-to-ACCUMULATE — EVIS policy tailwind and demand inflection validate long-term EV thesis; near-term profit visibility limited pending EO signing. Watch AC Mobility-linked names.

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/8/2026	4/10/2026	%Chg
AC	543	543	0.00%
ACEN	2.98	2.97	-0.34%
AEV	30.1	29.8	-1.00%
ALI	18.38	18.08	-1.63%
AREIT	40.35	39.95	-0.99%
BDO	127.7	122.8	-3.84%
BPI	104.5	101.4	-2.97%
CBC	63.05	62.9	-0.24%
CNPF	33.5	32.2	-3.88%
CNVRG	12.74	12.5	-1.88%
DMC	10.3	10.22	-0.78%
EMI	15.7	15.44	-1.66%
GLO	1,660.00	1,650.00	-0.60%
GTCAP	527	513	-2.66%
ICT	729	720	-1.23%
JFC	173.9	169.5	-2.53%
JGS	29	28.7	-1.03%

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/8/2026	4/10/2026	%Chg
LTG	15	14.82	-1.20%
MBT	67.65	67.3	-0.52%
MER	610	608.5	-0.25%
MONDE	6.72	6.67	-0.74%
PGOLD	42.25	41.7	-1.30%
PLUS	17.6	16.8	-4.55%
RCR	7	6.9	-1.43%
SCC	30.7	30.05	-2.12%
SM	631	621	-1.58%
SMC	71	69.3	-2.39%
SMPH	21	20.4	-2.86%
TEL	1,310.00	1,300.00	-0.76%
URC	62.7	62	-1.12%

TRENDING STOCKS

DIVIDEND YIELD INDEX (PSE DivY)

	4/8/2026	4/10/2026	%Chg
AREIT	10.2	9.98	-2.16%
CBC	19.28	18.4	-4.56%
CREIT	43.5	42	-3.45%
DMC	2.17	2.09	-3.69%
DNL	7.2	7.1	-1.39%
GLO	3.85	3.81	-1.04%
LTG	272	270	-0.74%
MBT	2.24	2.23	-0.45%
MER	2.1	2.07	-1.43%
MREIT	14	13.76	-1.71%
NIKL	43.6	42	-3.67%
OGP	4.88	4.72	-3.28%
PGOLD	36	34.85	-3.19%
RCR	59	58.25	-1.27%
RLC	18.08	17.88	-1.11%
RRHI	47	46.1	-1.91%
SCC	69.3	68.05	-1.80%
SGP	34.85	34	-2.44%
TEL	23.3	22.85	-1.93%
URC	6.72	6.56	-2.38%

TRENDING STOCKS

PSE MidCap

	4/8/2026	4/10/2026	%Chg
AGI	9.98	10	0.20%
APX	15.8	17.38	10.00%
AUB	42	42.1	0.24%
BLOOM	2.06	2.17	5.34%
COSCO	7.01	7.04	0.43%
DNL	3.65	3.76	3.01%
GSMI	272	270	-0.74%
KEEPR	2.12	2.15	1.42%
MEG	2.07	2.09	0.97%
MREIT	13.8	13.92	0.87%
MWC	42.45	43.5	2.47%
NIKL	4.5	4.72	4.89%
OGP	33.5	35	4.48%
PNB	56.3	57.6	2.31%
RLC	17.3	17.54	1.39%
RRHI	45.7	45.85	0.33%
SECB	65.85	67.5	2.51%
SEVN	34.5	35.5	2.90%
SGP	22.4	22.8	1.79%
WLCON	6.2	6.46	4.19%